

True Love Is Reality

*A collection of love, loss, despair, and survival —
words from my past*

DEWAYNE A. DICKERSON

The Nomadic Barber

*For anyone who has loved hard, lost more
than most, fell into despair — and found a
way to grow and move forward.*

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First Edition

Foreword

These words are a collection of my life — love, loss, despair, and depression — carried through my military career and the road that followed. They are words from my past. If they reach you in your own hard season, know that you are not alone.

— DeWayne A. Dickerson

The Nomadic Barber

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Love

poems of the heart

My First Love

My First Love

It was as if it was meant to be.
When I first saw her, it was like
love at first sight.

Her eyes were like honey shining in the sun,
and her lips like soft rose petals.
Her body like an hourglass.

When she smiles, she gives me a warm
feeling inside. When she talks, it's like
listening to beautiful music.
When I'm with her I want to hold her tight.

Then, when I'm home alone, I think
how it would be to be your man.
When I'm with you it seems I'm on cloud nine,
and that all time has stopped.
That is when I knew it was true love.

Dance for Me

Dance for Me

Can you dance for me — shaking, winding
your body the way you do at the party?
I can't stop thinking of your body
gliding on the floor as the lights
flicker over you.

Can you dance for me — shaking, winding
your body the way you do at the party?
You have me waking in a cold sweat
thinking it's me you're moving with.
All I want is one dance with you,
so my heart will stop its pining.

Can you be my private dancer, my only dancer?
You're my honey. I know how all this
must sound so funny.

You Are

You Are

You are my light. You shine brighter
than the lighthouse whose beam burns
bright to guide the ships home.

You are my friend to the end. You
see my tears and take them away
with a word: that it's okay.

You are my sun. With one smile you
warm my heart the way the sun
warms the earth.

You are my all. You are every thing
I could have asked for. You are my world.

Cupid's Arrow

Cupid's Arrow

As the days grow longer and the nights
grow short, I realized that Cupid
has struck me with his arrow —
thinking of the night I asked you
to be mine forever.

When I close my eyes I know why
your love lifts me higher than ever before.
You're my chosen lover and friend.
I'm so glad you chose me to be your man.

Tears of joy run down my face
when I think of the love you've given me.
Whenever I'm near you I fall deeper
than before — because Cupid's arrow never lies.

Why

Why

Why does the sun come up in the morning,
and why does the rain fall?

Can you tell me why love feels
the way it does when I'm with you?

Do you know that my mission is to please you?
Good loving is what I intend to give you.

Why is it? Could it be you're such
a wonderful lady, one who deserves
all my love and attention?

When your body grows weary, can I touch you
to make you feel good inside?
For you I'd climb a mountain
or travel a thousand miles for your love.

Your love gives me a strength
that not even the seven seas
could keep me from.

Spell Bound

Spell Bound

Who could have known we'd be spending
forever together? Every day is your birthday.
When I'm far away from you, my heart
cries out that I love you.
I know you hear my heart calling.

You have me spellbound with every smile
you've given me. I want to be —
I've got to be — your one and only.
You never have to be alone anymore.
You've got me saying no
when my heart is saying yes.

To give you a piece of my love is all
I have to show you that I love you.
It's funny how love goes.

Who could have guessed I'd be asking you
to spend the rest of our lives together?

You Are My Joy

You Are My Joy

You are my joy, you are my heart.

Your love for me has shown me
there is no one above you.

It would seem Cupid's arrow
has struck me deep in my heart.

I yearn for your love, your touch —
because all I do or say is about you.

"You are my joy, my heart and soul."

I'm willing to put our love to the test
for our happiness. Your love is like finding
a four-leaf clover in the middle of a bed of roses.

"You are my joy, my heart and soul."

This is why I'd give up everything I own
to be with you — because you are my joy.

It's Our Anniversary

It's Our Anniversary

I think of the time we've spent as one.
Could it really be two years
that we've been married?

So this anniversary, love, let's not waste
a minute. Let's give the love we both desire.
Take my hand and let me lead you to the tub,
where I'll wash your hair and your back
as we sit in the water, filled with bubbles
and rose petals to set the mood.

There's a table set for two, surrounded
by candlelight, with the fragrance of oils
and roses in the air.
Your love is unconditional.

You're the only one — the only one
who could ever light my world so brightly.

And every year I will say it again:
that this day, above all the others,

is ours.

You've Been

You've Been

The years have really flown by
since we fell in love.

They've brought me new meaning,
to love you more and more.

You've been my lover, my friend,
my partner and my pal.

You've been strong when I needed
a shoulder to lean on,
and tender when I needed you
to listen and understand.

I haven't always told you how much
I appreciated you. You're the one
who makes my heart beat fast,
the one I want to come home to,
the one I'll always love.

Because you've been my rock, and my love.

Life as an Apple

Life as an Apple

My life as an apple started as a little bud
among other buds on the tree.

As the days went by I grew stronger,
larger. As the months passed I came of age,
my skin a bright red — waiting for the day
when one person would see my worth.

The moment came, and you pulled me
from my branch, admiring my skin
that carried no blemish.

You cradled me, giving your attention
to me only. You raised me to your mouth,
so soft. You took a bite, and as you pulled away
the sweet juice ran down the side of your mouth.

You liked the apple — you took one last bite,
and I was happy to fill your hunger.
Now all that's left is the core, which is really me:
my shell gone, nothing left to hide my feelings.

Love Is Like a Puzzle

Love Is Like a Puzzle

They say love is like a puzzle.

Love has many pieces, as a puzzle does.

You never know which pieces of love will fit.

Sometimes you feel as if you've found
the right pieces to complete you,
only to find out you were trying too hard
to make the pieces fit.

Like a puzzle, and like love —
when you get the right pieces,
you see how wonderful it is.
So look closely before you try to make
that piece a part of your puzzle.

To Share My World

To Share My World

To share my world is what I want
to do with you — to share my deepest
hopes and dreams with you.

I'm not sure what it will take for you
to share my world. I don't have fancy things,
but I have love the size of the biggest mountain
to share with you.

Let there be no doubt that this love
is here to stay. Let our love and our life
be an inspiration to others in love —
to love till the end of time.

Loss

distance, despair, and letting go

Don't Go

Don't Go

I lie in our bed, tossing and turning,
waking in a cold sweat, wondering
if God will bring your love back to me.

Baby, don't go — even though time has shown
that love has somehow dwindled.
Remember the nights we shared,
the times I played in your hair.
It can't end like this.

"Don't go, no don't — my love is here for you."

I want to hold you once more in my arms.
I know you don't want to give up.
I'm your man, and tears run down my face
to know that I may lose you.

"Don't go, no don't — my love is here for you."

We have so many things to share,
so much to learn from each other.

You said we'd grow old together.

Don't go, no don't — my love is here for you.

Life without you is like living in a world
with nothing to look forward to.

So don't go and leave me in a world
filled with hate and loneliness.

Don't Say Goodbye

Don't Say Goodbye

Please don't walk out of my life
without so much as a fight.
I know I treated you wrong,
so let me try to make it right.

By night your love is trying to fly
out of my life like a sparrow.

"Can't you see I can change to keep you
in my life? I know the pain I gave —
so don't say goodbye,
because it's your love that keeps me high."

The way you're feeling, I can see
your heart needs healing.
So give me the chance to fix the pieces
with a love meant for your mending.

I know now I was a fool to think
it was cool to treat you the way I did.
I know where I belong,

and I know I was wrong.

What Do You See

What Do You See

Oh, is it so late that I have hurt you
and caused your heart pain?

If so, you should know me by now —
know that I would die before I hurt you.

What do you see when you look inside
your soul? Is it a love that can still grow,
willing to pick up the broken pieces
of your heart and mend them together
with our love as one?

I know what we need is each other.
When we say goodbye, I realize how
I miss your love each time
I'm away from your touch.

Let's take some time away, just you and I,
because your love is the only one
I want in my life.

I've found an unconditional love in you.
Others are still looking for the love
I've already found.

This love comes from my heart
with all my walls down.
Please give us another try
before love is too late.

You'll Never Hear Me Say

19 May 1999

You'll Never Hear Me Say

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You'll never hear me say I adore you.

You'll never hear me say I care.

You'll never hear me say you're my all.

You'll never hear these three words: I love you.

I remember you saying you loved me.

Was it all a lie? I thought I brought you joy.

Now I know I was only your toy.

You were my queen — but it turned out
you were just a fiend.

Now you've given your love to another,
trying to keep it undercover.

You thought I'd never discover
you had another lover.

Can't you see the pain in my eyes?

So pack your bags, your cover's been blown,
and my house is no longer a home.

So I must move on.

Do What I Have to Do

Do What I Have to Do

Know that I sit here thinking about
the first time we met. It was wrong —
even though you may say
how can a love that feels this good be wrong.

The fun times we shared, the love we made.
Now that I've looked deep in my heart,
I know I must do what I have to do
to stop this love triangle
before we get any closer.

You have a man, and I have my girl
I never wanted to hurt.
Our love was good for the moment,
but I must do what I've got to do,
even though the love I feel for you has grown.
So I must do what I've got to do,
even if it means I must let you go.
I will always love you.

Time Has Come

Time Has Come

As the days go by and the time draws near,
I know there's no time left for fear.
The time I spent with you was great,
and now I must go and make a man of myself —
but I will always remember the love
and the friendship you gave me.

Eyes of Destruction

Eyes of Destruction

Whose eyes are these that sit and wait,
watching for the hour to strike?
Whose eyes are waiting to set fear
and doubt down into our lives?
Whose eyes can laugh to see us cry —
the eyes of destruction.

Our nation, once so strong, so free,
now a nation asking how this could be.
Thousands of lives taken by a thief
in a matter of moments.
Now as a nation we look to God
for some kind of closure,
asking Him to bring the guilty to justice,
be it by peace or by force.

So our course has been set for us,
marked out by the acts of destruction.
Now we fight for all that is right.
We fight so freedom lives forever.

So let our voices be heard, loud and clear,
as we shout: united we stand, beaten we are not.
We shall overcome the eyes of destruction.

Hope

survival, and what comes after

Today Is All We Have

Today Is All We Have

It's six o'clock, and I see the tears
fall from your face in sadness.
It hurts to see you cry,
so I walk over to see why.

You say you cry because of the way
our relationship has turned for the worse,
and how distant we have become.

I say I'm sorry, baby, but I realize
sorry isn't going to fix the problems.
I took you for granted, and that's not
how I wanted it to be.

You are my candle in the window.
Take my hand and let's wander off, just us two,
to that place where love once was.
Let's start with the actions of today
and not the actions of yesterday —
because today is all we have.

The Wheel of Fortune of Life

The Wheel of Fortune of Life

Spin my wheel and take a chance
on the wheel of fortune of life.
Spin, and ride the roller coaster of life.

Will you hit the life full of love,
or land on the life of hate?
Or will you land on the life full of trust?

Or will you wind up on the American dream —
family, a nice house with a fence,
children and a dog?
So what will your spin land on
with the wheel of fortune of life?

I'll Turn to You

I'll Turn to You

I ask you: are you the woman
who can un-break my heart,
the one that's been torn apart
by this thing called love?

It's true, I didn't want to be alone anymore.
I thought I'd never find the likes of yours —
till last summer, when you said,
"You don't have to hurt anymore."

I know they say a man shouldn't cry,
but these are tears of joy.
Every time I close my eyes and think of you,
it brings nothing but joy to my heart.

Now that we are one, I'm glad we waited.
Because of it, our love has grown
stronger over time. So come here,
and let's have a night alone — just the two of us.

So Many Times

So Many Times

So many times we've talked about
having a good life with that special one.
Who knew the life we wanted
was with each other?

So many times — and who knew,
all along, that you were the one?

You were there for me and I was there
for you to lean on when times were bad.
No one can compare to the love
and friendship you've shown me.

Let's be true with each other,
because loving you is all I want to do.
So don't turn away from my heart —
there's no greater love than yours.

Let's not deny what we feel inside.
Be my friend, my lover and my wife,
because I have so much love to give.

So many times — and it was always you.

Our Time Has Come

Our Time Has Come

Is this a dream or is it real?
Have my eyes spotted love
in a world filled with war and hate?

I feel as if every day is a special day
when you are here with me.
I want the world to know
that I profess my love to you only.

Our time has come and this love is real,
so come and get my love.

Make a wish on these candles —
that the joy we share is now reality,
a miracle sent from above.

It's okay to be afraid.
We can make our steps together as one,
because our time has come.

The Bright Star

The Bright Star

As I look into the sky, the stars all shine
the same, all serving the purpose
of brightening the sky —
all waiting for their time
to shine the brightest.

To shine brighter than the brightest light.
To be bigger than the biggest mountain.
So would I like to be like the stars,
who pick the right time
to shine bright and strong.

All My Days

All My Days

Oh, how I have walked to find
the true meaning of Black history —
to see how my history could make me
feel like a winner, or make me one.

I would have figured it was the pain
we went through way back then,
but it runs deeper than that.

As I walked, I heard the birds singing.
It reminded me of my forefathers singing
when times were hard. Through singing,
my people felt like birds — that when they sang,
it made them believe they could one day
be as the bird that flies free about the world.

I found myself smiling that they paved
a way for us to follow, and gave us heroes
to look to, so that we may pass this on
to our children. I'll keep my eyes on the prize.

Don't be fooled: the big prize is not riches
or the American way, but the history
left here by others for us to use —
to show us that we are all winners.

So I turn to you today and ask:
what will you choose? Will you choose
to learn your history, or let it die away
so that no one hears or sees how far
we have come as a people?

So that everyone knows Black history
is not just one month out of a year —
so everyone, of all colors, can learn
our history as well as their own.

So I say to you: all of my days will be used
to pass on that Black history should be known
by all who hear or read what I have to say.

The Best Is Yet to Come

The Best Is Yet to Come

As I sit here looking over the open seas,
I find myself missing you
with every breath I take —
and I know the best is yet to come.

I'm waiting for the moment to hold you
close once more, to give you what
no one else could ever give you.

With all my heart I know that
to be complete in this world,
my place is to be with you.

I know the best is yet to come.

I love you more than the many stars
in the sky, because your love
is all that matters.

So this day, like any other day,
just keeps getting better,

and I devote my life, my love and my trust
to the one person who means the world to me.
Yes — oh yes — the best is yet to come.

Let's Celebrate

Let's Celebrate

Let's celebrate this special day.

This is the time we've always
looked forward to.

So let's celebrate our lives together —
the good times and the bad.

What would I have ever done without you?

Let's celebrate under the moon's light,
enjoying each other over a long walk
on the beach, and dinner.

I'll never take you for granted.

So let's celebrate a life of growth and trust.

Let's just celebrate our love that's true.

True Love Is Reality

True Love Is Reality

I've found what the world is looking for.
It's true love that makes the world go round.
It's been here since the beginning of time.
You feel like giving your all for love.

Reality is what brings two people together.
I've found love in you — your love, your trust,
and the happiness in your heart.

True love is reality:
to feel you can never give enough love.
This is reality — to miss one another
even for an hour, to praise you to my friends
and want to shout with joy,
to feel like singing songs of love
when I'm with you.

I've found love in you, and now this is real.
I've never felt love so special before.
Just a smile on your face brings such joy.

This is the real meaning of true love:
to give your love unconditionally.
So I'm holding on to love, right here, right now.

Reality, reality — yes, the reality
you give me is true. This is why I said
the love you give is true,
because your true love is the reality.

About the Author

DeWayne A. Dickerson writes as The Nomadic Barber. These poems were written across a military career and the road that followed — years spent far from home, learning what it costs to love, to lose, and to keep a standard when everything familiar is somewhere else. He is also the author of The Nomadic Barber Grooming Guide, a global grooming methodology for professionals and travelers.

— The Nomadic Barber

*Wherever you go,
your standards travel with you.*